

Runway to feature freeze

Eight file types are working and tested. The media formats finish through September, every feature is complete and frozen by 31 October, and November is spent making the tool production-ready.

17 September 2026

8 file types working today	583 automated tests, all passing	13 file types at the freeze	31 known limits written down
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WHERE WE STAND TODAY

Four of the six build phases are finished: the testing foundation, images, audio and documents. Photos, music, PDFs and Word files all scrub cleanly, and every result is backed by an automated test rather than a claim. Phase 4 — the camera and video formats — opened last week with iPhone photos.

THE THREE MONTHS

30 Sep

Media formats

iPhone photos finished, video added

- **Finish iPhone photos.** The remaining test coverage and the published results for HEIC.
- **Add video.** MP4 reuses most of the groundwork already laid during the audio phase, so it is the cheapest format left.
- **Begin camera RAW** with a survey of what the major camera makers actually put in their files, before any code is written.

9 file types · Phase 4 two-thirds done

31 Oct

Feature complete

Every format in, and the tool usable in bulk

- **Camera RAW** closes the media phase. The leak that matters is the full-size preview image hidden inside every RAW file, carrying its own copy of the camera and location data.
- **Program files** — Windows, Mac and Linux executables, which carry traces of the machine that built them. The rule here is that the program must still run afterwards.
- **Archives and the remaining image types** — ZIP, EPUB, TIFF, WebP, SVG, GIF. An archive is cleaned by cleaning everything inside it.
- **Bulk use.** Whole folders in one command, and a single published results sheet covering every supported format.

13 file types · every phase closed · feature freeze

30 Nov

Hardening

Production readiness

- **Robustness.** Make certain that broken or hostile files are refused safely rather than half-processed.
- **Performance.** Measure speed and memory on large files — nothing on that is measured today.
- **Packaging.** A proper install, and automated testing on Mac as well as Linux.
- **Documentation and release.** The final write-up of what the tool can and cannot do, and the release candidate.

Release candidate

WHAT STAYS AFTER NOVEMBER

A few limits remain, and they are worth stating once rather than discovering later. Some traces live in the content itself rather than in the metadata — the faint noise a camera sensor leaves in every photograph, or the way a particular program arranged a page — and removing them would damage the file. These are recorded as documented limits, not left as unfinished work.